

LOL

Anti-vaxxers petrified of COVID-19

Anti-Vaxxers Are terrified the government will mandate a vaccine for COVID-19 or coronavirus. <https://digit.in/mar20-79>

WTF

Twitter verified a fake account

Twitter verified the account of Andrew Walz, a congressional candidate. Andrew Walz is actually a high school student. <https://digit.in/mar20-81>

UPGRADE NOW OR FOREVER HOLD YOUR PEACE

Or at least till COVID-19 has run its course

Agent001 | agent001@digit.in



2

O2O is going to be a challenging year for everyone, yes everyone. COVID-19 is spreading fast and is

expected to infect a large portion of the human race because of its virality. Every country on the surface of the planet is planning and preparing for COVID-19 and rightly so. Individual countries have announced that they're on the verge of an epidemic and it won't be long before the WHO declares COVID-19 as a pandemic. Governments and major industries have all started preparing their pandemic plans in anticipation of the worst. The hardware manufacturing companies are in for a rough ride given how most of the manufacturing actually happens in Shenzhen and Taiwan.

We got to experience the effects of COVID-19 in January itself as review samples slated to arrive at our offices in early February got held back in Hong Kong indefinitely. Apparently container ships are leaving numerous ports in the region at only 10 per cent capacity. While container ships do make several stops to pick up and drop off more containers, it's very unusual for a ship to depart with such few containers from the very first port. These sea shipments are how the whole world gets their technology hardware. That includes us.

What's even more worrying is that India has never been a high-volume

country for PC hardware since we barely buy anything compared to the likes of US or Europe. This is also why we don't get enough allocation for products. When something new is launched, the vast majority of the initial stock goes to markets where it is more likely to get sold. Naturally, the US and Europe get first pickings. We're lucky enough to get included in later batches of new product launches.



Now, factor in the fact that all companies are going to see their bottom lines severely affected because of the reduction in global sales. Obviously, companies would want to modify shipment allocation to maximise revenues. This would mean more products will be allocated to countries where they are more likely to be sold for certain. There's the fact that reduced supply and greater demand will lead to prices skyrocketing. Since India is a price sensitive market and the whole world knows about this, we are less likely to buy stuff that appears to be overpriced.

Let's summarise. Shipments are low, allocation is low, prices will shoot up and we're not going to buy stuff at high prices. In the short term, we're going to see some nasty pricing for PC hardware given that barely anything is manufactured locally. In the long run, we might see course corrections but the entire market will see an upheaval. If you're planning on holding out your next PC upgrade for the next major launch from Intel, AMD or NVIDIA, then you might want to reconsider that decision. If your PC is good to last for the next two years, then you don't need to upgrade.

Why two years? Well, the closest thing to COVID-19 was the SARS Epidemic that began in China in 2002 and went on to spread to 26 countries over the course of one whole year. No transmission has been recorded since 2004, so effectively, the virus hung around for about two years. COVID-19 spreads way quicker than SARS, so we might see this epidemic get over much earlier than the two years that SARS took but it's still too early to tell. Traditional methods of projection are still all over the place and experts are yet to figure everything out so we don't know for certain. All you need to know is that if you need to upgrade, then now's the time. And if your PC has enough horsepower to easily last two more years, then you might as well upgrade after this whole thing has run its course. 